torture? Answers such as “The public has the right to know,” “The obligation to investigate is growing,” and “We must get to the root of the problem” often conceal the interests and motives of various parties.

In spite of my intensive involvement in the Agranat Commission, which I described at the beginning of this chapter, I was indifferent to the subject whenever it came up on the media’s agenda during the forty years between 1973 and 2013. In mid-2013, following the authorization to publish an additional segment of the Agranat Commission report (which had been confidential until then), a well-known journalist launched into a diatribe in three long newspaper columns, casuistically concluding that then-Mossad chief Zvi Zamir was guilty of the failures of the Yom Kippur War. This cracked my indifference and compelled me to come out publicly in defense of the Mossad and its director during the war.

I did not invent the maxim that if the intelligence is good there is no need for assessment, but I do maintain, from my personal familiarity with every detail of intelligence that the Mossad provided to MI, that if there is a historical case that proves the truth of this statement, the Yom Kippur War is it. Moreover, I believe that any intelligent reader looking over the samples of intelligence I present in this chapter cannot help but reach the same conclusion—that with such intelligence, assessment is superfluous.

The wealth of intelligence material clearly pointing to Egypt and Syria’s intentions and capabilities (examples of which have been presented here) casts the total reliance on the warning provided on the eve of the war in a completely different light. This intelligence was already being systematically transferred to MI by the Mossad by the end of the War of Attrition, and therefore all explanations regarding the “concept” must be directed toward MI and not others. The “concept” is the name given by the State Committee of Inquiry headed by Chief Justice Agranat to a theory that was developed and formed by the MI in the early 1970s. According to the “concept,” Egypt would not go to war against Israel unless it had certain advanced weapons— low-flying bombers and/or long-range surface-to-surface ballistic missiles—which would grant it strategic balance vis-à-vis Israel, and Syria would not go to war without Egypt. The “concept” led MI to the assessment that the Arab military deployment in the days just before the breakout of the 1973 War did not necessarily indicate an intention to go to war, in spite of numerous signs to the contrary.